FROM MY FOURTH TRIMESTER PLAN

Ways to help

In these weeks a new mother's work is to rest, heal, feed, and be with her baby. Everything else can be shared. Choose any task, let her know, and do it in your own way.

For _____

and baby _____

Call or text _____

Circled: help I would love · ○ ○ ○ nice to have · ○ ○ ○ would love · ○ ○ ○ most important

Care for the baby, close by

- ○ ○ ○ Change diapers, then bring the baby back to me
- ○ ○ ○ Burp and settle the baby after feeds
- ○ ○ ○ Hold the baby skin to skin while I sleep or shower
- ○ ○ ○ Carry the baby in a wrap or carrier for a short walk
- ○ ○ ○ Bathe the baby, when we are ready
- ○ ○ ○ Restock diapers, wipes, and clothes by the bed and the changing area
- ○ ○ ○ Keep a simple log of feeds and diapers in the first week
- ○ ○ ○ Learn the baby's early hunger cues, so you can bring her to me before she cries
- ○ ○ ○ Drive us to the baby's checkups

Feeding

- ○ ○ ○ Set up a feeding nest: pillows, water, snacks, a phone charger, a burp cloth
- ○ ○ ○ Bring me water and a snack at every feed
- ○ ○ ○ Wash and dry pump parts and bottles
- ○ ○ ○ Bring the baby to me for night feeds
- ○ ○ ○ Help me reach a lactation consultant or a breastfeeding group
- ○ ○ ○ Prepare bottles, if we use them, the way I have asked

Meals and nutrition

- ○ ○ ○ Organize a meal train
- ○ ○ ○ Fill the freezer with meals before the birth
- ○ ○ ○ Cook warm, nourishing meals: soups, stews, broths
- ○ ○ ○ Make breakfast I can eat with one hand
- ○ ○ ○ Keep a snack basket stocked: nuts, fruit, cheese, crackers
- ○ ○ ○ Keep my water bottle filled beside me
- ○ ○ ○ Plan the week's meals with my food notes in mind
- ○ ○ ○ Wash up after meals

Groceries

- ○ ○ ○ Make the grocery list with me
- ○ ○ ○ Do the weekly shop, or order a delivery
- ○ ○ ○ Pick up top-ups: milk, bread, fruit
- ○ ○ ○ Put the groceries away
- ○ ○ ○ Pick up pads, nipple cream, and other recovery supplies

Household and cleaning

- ○ ○ ○ Tidy the main rooms
- ○ ○ ○ Clean the kitchen
- ○ ○ ○ Clean the bathroom
- ○ ○ ○ Vacuum or sweep
- ○ ○ ○ Change the bed sheets
- ○ ○ ○ Take out the trash and recycling
- ○ ○ ○ Water the plants
- ○ ○ ○ Keep the house warm, and open a window for fresh air

Laundry

- ○ ○ ○ Wash, dry, and fold laundry
- ○ ○ ○ Wash the baby's clothes and blankets
- ○ ○ ○ Put clean clothes away
- ○ ○ ○ Keep clean towels and burp cloths stocked

Errands

- ○ ○ ○ Pharmacy pickups
- ○ ○ ○ Post office, packages, and returns
- ○ ○ ○ Bills and banking
- ○ ○ ○ Fuel the car and check the car seat
- ○ ○ ○ Pick up anything else I need

Older children

- ○ ○ ○ School or daycare drop-offs and pick-ups
- ○ ○ ○ Playdates and outings
- ○ ○ ○ Meals and snacks for them
- ○ ○ ○ Help with homework
- ○ ○ ○ Help at bedtime
- ○ ○ ○ Special one-on-one time with each child

Pets

- ○ ○ ○ Feeding
- ○ ○ ○ Walks
- ○ ○ ○ Litter or cleaning
- ○ ○ ○ Vet visits

Care for my body

- ○ ○ ○ Hold the baby while I shower or bathe
- ○ ○ ○ Run a warm bath or a sitz bath
- ○ ○ ○ Restock pads, ice packs, and comfort supplies
- ○ ○ ○ Help me get up and to the bathroom in the first days
- ○ ○ ○ Remind me to take any medication or vitamins
- ○ ○ ○ A foot rub, a massage, or a hand on my back
- ○ ○ ○ Help with my hair
- ○ ○ ○ Drive me to my postpartum checkup
- ○ ○ ○ Help me book a pelvic floor physiotherapist, if I need one

Rest and sleep

- ○ ○ ○ Protect one long stretch of sleep for me each day
- ○ ○ ○ Take a night shift
- ○ ○ ○ Keep the bedroom dark and quiet
- ○ ○ ○ Hold the baby skin to skin so I can nap
- ○ ○ ○ Turn visitors away kindly when I am resting

Emotional care and connection

- ○ ○ ○ A daily check-in: how are you, really?
- ○ ○ ○ Listen to my birth story without fixing it
- ○ ○ ○ Sit with me on hard nights
- ○ ○ ○ Remind me that I am doing well
- ○ ○ ○ Watch for signs I am struggling, and help me reach support
- ○ ○ ○ Bring me outside for fresh air or sun
- ○ ○ ○ Keep me company, without needing me to host

Visitors and messages

- ○ ○ ○ Share the news and updates for us
- ○ ○ ○ Answer messages and calls
- ○ ○ ○ Schedule visits and keep them short
- ○ ○ ○ Remind visitors to wash their hands, and to stay home if unwell
- ○ ○ ○ Keep track of gifts and thank-you notes

Paperwork

- ○ ○ ○ Register the birth and order the birth certificate
- ○ ○ ○ Add the baby to our health insurance
- ○ ○ ○ Parental leave and work forms
- ○ ○ ○ Keep a calendar of appointments and bills

Thank you for holding us, so we can hold our baby.